

Thompson poet has book published in India



Thompson poet Sukh "Sue" Deepak Khokhar has recently had her book entitled 'Walking In Dreams', published in India through the sponsorship of the Modern European Languages Literary Society, Punjab University Campus, Chandigarh, India. The book is an anthology of lyrics.

A recent visit to India, her first in eight years, coincided with the unveiling of the first run of her book which was unveiled at a special meeting of the Literary Society and was attended by approximately 200 people including several outstanding people in the literary field, as well as students.

Sue's father, the late Sardar G.S. Deepak, was a well known Indian poet, folk dancer and singer. Yet despite the fact that she was brought up in an artistic environment she found it difficult to express her feelings on paper and only began writing poetry after her father's death in 1968. "It was an outlet for my grief," she said in an interview with the Citizen.

However, her father obviously had a significant influence on her life and she has dedicated her book to his memory.

'Walking In Dreams', is based upon her own dreams reflecting beauty and love. For example "Colours of Rainbow On My Life," which she wrote during the early days when she met her husband.

Colours of Rainbow

Whenever a rainbow of colours, went swimming by,
In the shape of birds, on a colourful sky.

A part of my soul, passed through me,
To mingle with the colours,

to colourfully flee.

These silky wings,
which colourfully appeared,
made to my heart, there secret clear.

When a pair of eyes, glanced through mine.

Two tender hands, in mine entwined.

Casually my glance swept through skies,

Few silky wings went fluttering by,

Throwing the colours of rainbow, on my life.

Almost all of her poems have a lyrical quality that makes them easily adapted to music - either classical, or modern. This was done deliberately as Sue hopes that someday her poems will be set to music.

Prior to coming to Canada Sue studied at the Punjab University and was quite familiar with their Literary Society program. However, it wasn't until after she had sent her book to a printer that she decided to approach the Society for support.

They were not only delighted with her poems and took over publication and sponsorship, but have made arrangements to also do the printing after the first edition (500 books) has run out. They also plan to illustrate the second edition as well as design a new cover.

Sue said that signing a contract with the Society not only relieves her of the headaches involved of promoting a book in another country, but the Society also has the advantage of having translators on staff. This means that her book of lyrics could conceivably be printed in other languages.

We would like to thank